

Farida Marchetti

Character Dossier

Proud of a craft nobody appreciates radio operator of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon

Overview

Farida Marchetti is a radio operator living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Farida is 74 years old, originally from Bittermoor, and is known around the Reading Well as proud of a craft nobody appreciates. In conversation Farida speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Background

Farida arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 21 years ago after leaving Bittermoor under circumstances Farida describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Farida works as a radio operator near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Farida learned the trade from Yusuf Achterberg, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Farida's life is with Soren Ravensworth, over a matter neither will explain. The person Farida trusts most is Ursula Greywind.

Current goal: to prove Soren Ravensworth wrong about the old tunnels. Greatest fear: letting Ursula Greywind down.

Personality and speech

Temperament: proud of a craft nobody appreciates.

Speech pattern: Farida speaks softly and expects people to lean in.

Tells: when lying, Farida mentions Waffles the toad for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Farida Marchetti
Role	radio operator
Home	the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon
Hometown	Bittermoor
Age	74
Favourite dish	twice-cooked ginger duck
Pet	Waffles, a toad

<i>Lucky number</i>	982
<i>Workshop password</i>	ash-vane
<i>Mentor</i>	Yusuf Achterberg
<i>Rival</i>	Soren Ravensworth
<i>Closest friend</i>	Ursula Greywind

Secret

Farida was the one who let the animals loose during the festival three years ago.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Farida: I am the radio operator. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Farida: Twice-cooked ginger duck. Do not tell Soren I said so.

Visitor: Is Waffles yours?

Farida: Waffles belongs to nobody. Waffles tolerates me. Lucky number is 982, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, summer of year 11

Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Farida suspects Ursula and is probably right. Farida repaired the pair of spectacles at the Reading Well for Zubair, who paid in 39 ink-weights and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Farida repaired the sack of salt at the Reading Well for Viggo, who paid in 88 ink-weights and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 2, summer of year 11

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Archivist's cell. Farida pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Farida closed early, walked to the Reading Well, and watched the lights come on. Waffles followed at a distance. Xanthe came by asking about the missing shipment. Farida said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 3, autumn of year 11

Farida repaired the brass lantern at the cataloguers' gallery for Zeph, who paid in 36 ink-weights and a long story about the census. A stranger asked Farida for the password to the workshop. Farida laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A stranger asked Farida for the password to the workshop. Farida laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.